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INTERIM REVISION OF
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August 29, 1973

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

NAPKINS, TABLE, PAPER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification UU-N-1650A, dated August 29, 1973.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. The specification covers white, single-ply, 2-ply, and 3-ply, creped or embossed napkins.

1.2 Classification. Paper napkins in accordance with this specification shall be of the following types and classes:

Type I - Eighth-folded, 3-ply napkin.
Type II - Folded, single-ply napkin.
  Class 1 - Junior dispenser napkin.
  Class 2 - Senior dispenser napkin.
  Class 3 - Quarter-folded napkin.
Type III - Eighth-folded, 2-ply napkin.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

RR-D-500 - Dispenser, Paper Napkin.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent.

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards.

T 404 - Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.
T 410 - Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 432 - Water Absorption of Bibulous Paper
T 452 - Brightness of Paper.
T 456 - Wet Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Paper napkins shall be made of fibrous material and shall conform to the physical requirements of table I. The material offered shall contain not less than 60 percent of recovered materials. Recovered materials are defined as material which has been collected or recovered from solid waste. Solid waste is defined as any garbage, refuse, sludge from a waste treatment plant, water supply treatment plant, or air pollution control facility and other discarded material, including solid, liquid, semisolid, or contained gaseous material resulting from industrial, commercial, mining, and agricultural operations, and from community activities, but does not include solid or dissolved material in domestic sewage, or solid or dissolved materials in irrigation return flows or industrial discharges.

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TABLE I. Physical requirements 1/

Characteristic	Type I	Type II	Type III
Plies	3	1	2
Basis weight (24 x 36-500) pounds, minimum	30	12.5	20
Dry tensile strength Cross machine direction, minimum	-	0.10 kilogram (kg) per 15 millimeters (mm)	-
Machine direction, minimum	-	0.268 kg/15 mm	-
Wet tensile strength Cross machine direction, minimum	0.04 kg/15 mm	-	0.025 kg/15 mm
Machine direction, minimum	0.072 kg/15 mm	-	0.059 kg/15 mm
Absorption time, 0.01 milliliter (ml) water, maximum seconds	100	100	100
Brightness, percent, minimum	78	76	78

1/ Requirements are based on napkins, as received, i.e., single, two, or three ply.

3.2 Size.

3.2.1 Type I napkins. The area of each type I single sheet of napkin shall be not less than 272 square inches, with neither dimension less than 16 inches.

3.2.2 Type II napkins. The area of each junior dispenser napkin shall be not less than 104 square inches. The width shall be not less than 7-7/8 inches. The length shall be not less than 13 inches. The area of each senior dispenser napkin or quarter-folded napkin shall be not less than 149 square inches. Neither dimension shall be less than 11-1/4 inches. Dispenser type napkins shall be folded to comply with the following range of dimensions: width 3-3/8 to 3-5/8 inches, length 6-5/8 to 6-7/8 inches.

3.2.3 Type III napkins. The area of each type III single sheet of napkin shall be not less than 217 square inches, with neither dimension less than 14-1/2 inches.

3.3 Finish. Types I and III napkins shall be embossed clearly with a firm ply adhesion and the design must be such as to emboss all four sides of the border. The center may be plain or either partially or entirely embossed. Type II napkins shall be creped or embossed.

3.4 Plies. Type I napkins shall be 3-ply. Type II napkins shall be single ply. Type III napkins shall be 2-ply.

3.5 Odor. The napkins shall have no odor, either wet or dry.

3.6 Dispensing operation. Dispenser napkins (125 of type II, class 1 or class 2 as specified in 6.1) shall fit and feed satisfactorily (without tearing or dispensing more than one napkin at a time) when tested as specified in 4.4.6.

3.7 Color. All napkins shall be white in color, and of uniform color.

3.8 Cleanliness. All napkins shall be clean, free from dirt spots, holes, and tears.

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3.9 Workmanship. All napkins shall be square cut and trimmed with clean smooth edges. Types I and III shall be soft to the touch and lint free. The napkins shall be free from wrinkles.

3.10 Formation. The napkins shall be uniform in formation. Clumps of undisbursed fibers, or thin looking areas are evidence of poor formation.

3.11 Comparison sample. The color, cleanliness, workmanship, and formation shall at least equal the comparison sample furnished with the contract or purchase order. In all other respects, the specification shall apply.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3 Certification. A certificate shall be submitted with each bid specifying that the material to be supplied will contain the percentage of recovered material required herein.

4.4 Inspection of the end item.

4.4.1 Examination. Examination of the end item shall be made for the defects set forth in the applicable paragraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) specified.

4.4.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective.

4.4.3 Examination for visual defects. The napkins shall be examined for the defects listed below. The sample unit shall be one napkin. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

Examine	Defects
Plies	Type I not 3-ply. Type II not single-ply. Type III not 2-ply.
Workmanship, color, formation, cleanliness	Does not compare favorably with comparison sample.
Finish	Not embossed or creped. Not folded as specified.

4.4.4 Examination for dimensional defects. The sample unit shall be one napkin. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. Defects shall be as follows:

Examine	Defect
Shortest dimension	Less than specified.
Area	Less than specified.

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4.4.5 Testing. The end item shall be tested for the applicable characteristics in table II, using the test methods shown therein. The sample unit shall be one package. The inspection level shall be S-1 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective. The value for each sample unit, using the TAPPI test methods in table II, shall be compared with the requirements of table I.

TABLE II. Testing of the end item

Characteristics	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Basis weight	Table I	T 410
Dry tensile strength	Table I	T 404
Wet tensile strength	Table I	T 456
Absorption time	Table I	T 432
Brightness	Table I	T 452
Dispensing operation	3.6	4.4.6

4.4.6 Dispensing. Load a dispenser conforming to RR-D-500 with 125 folded napkins (see 3.2.2 and 3.6). Withdraw ten napkins in consecutive order. Examine for conformance with requirements in 3.6.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A or commercial as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Napkins shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed, and banded in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Commercial. Napkins of one type and class only shall be packed in a fiberboard box in accordance with normal commercial practice. The complete pack shall be designed to protect the item against damage during shipment, handling and storage, to insure delivery at destination, to provide for redistribution by the initial receiving activity and be acceptable by common carrier under National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification.

5.2 Marking. Shipping containers and unitized loads (when applicable) shall be marked as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size desired (see 1.2, 3.2.1, 3.2.2 and 3.2.3).
(c) Packing required (see 5.1).
(d) Marking required (see 5.2).

6.2 Standard comparison samples may be obtained upon application to the procuring agency issuing the invitation for bids.

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6.3 The Department of Defense waives coordination on this specification.

User activities:

Army - GS
Navy - SA

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS

Preparing Activity:

GSA - FSS

Civil Agency Interest:

VA - DMS

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